

Getting Slow, Slow, Slower

Q I have a Wipro Super Genius 10845GL-m with a P4 1.7 GHz processor, 128 MB of RAM, a 40 GB HDD and an LG CD writer. I run Windows XP Home Edition with Service Pack 2. My problem is, the computer has recently gotten too slow. It takes ages to start applications. It takes almost five minutes to start applications such as Norton AntiVirus, Microsoft Outlook, Outlook Express, etc. I want a solution to this, and also want to learn how to re-install Windows.

Malay Kurwa

A To resolve the issue you will need to check a few important things. First, you need to open up the cabinet and check if dust is covering the parts. If it is, clean them with a dry cloth. Second, verify that the CPU fan is working properly. There should be no sudden increase or decrease in rotation speed. Clean the dust from the power supply and check the power supply fan movement as well. Finally, check if your machine is getting too hot when you use it for around 3 to 4 hours.



If it is, you need to improve the air flow and cooling. Depending upon your cabinet, try to add a system fan. Or else, keep the cabinet open when you plan to work for long.

On the software front, run **msconfig** and remove any unnecessary services that start up with Windows each time. Next, use **scandisk** to find and eliminate any errors. Also defragment your drive.

Installing Windows is a breeze. Just make a backup of all the important files on your C drive on any other partition. Also copy your Outlook or Outlook Express mail folders. If you want to format the C drive, you can do so during the install. Formatting is always recommended as it will erase all unnecessary files residing on the C drive—but do not

forget to take a backup of all your important files. Re-installing Windows will not affect any partition other than the one you do the installation on.

It could be due to a virus as well. Make sure you have anti-virus software that is up-to-date with the current virus definitions.

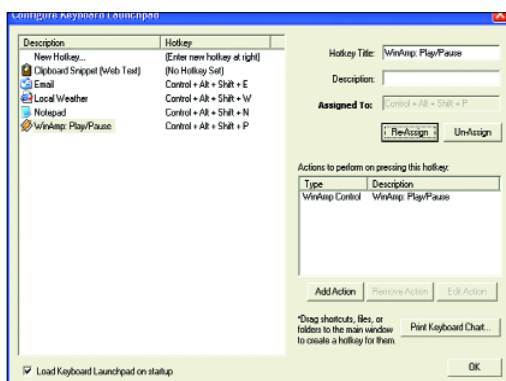
The PHP installer will add settings needed for PHP to work properly with IIS. It does not erase the settings ASP needs. Your ASP pages will work.

Assigning Hotkeys

Q I run Windows 98 on my computer, along with programs such as MS Office, PageMaker, etc. I want to use a tool called dictionary.exe along with these programs, and I want to assign a keyboard key to work as a hotkey for launching the application. How do I do it?

Nilesh Waghulde

A For assigning hotkeys, you can find free tools such as Keyboard Launchpad 1.0



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Sound Card Works With Win XP But Not With Win 98

Q I have a PC with an Intel Celeron 2 GHz processor with a D-Link motherboard, an Intel 845GV graphics controller, onboard Soundmax Digital Audio, a Motorola modem, and other stuff. The quality of the onboard sound is not as good as that from the PCI CMedia sound card, so I disabled onboard sound and installed the CMedia sound card. The problem is, it does not get detected in Windows 98 although it works perfectly with XP. Furthermore, it works fine at my friends place with Windows 98. What's up?

Sanju

A The problem would be due to a resource conflict with some other device on the system. To get around this problem, you should first check the BIOS settings, and disable all unused devices. Also verify that IR settings are set to Auto. If the problem persists, try installing the card in a different PCI slot. If you still have the problem, try removing other PCI cards, such as the modem, one by one, and see if the sound card gets detected. If it does not get detected even after removing all the other PCI cards, you will need to bring in an engineer.

Unable To Defrag

Q I have an HCL Infinity Pro with a 40 GB disk, divided into two 20 GB partitions. The problem is, in NTFS, Defragmenter does not work.